Port Brief

Port and shipping conditions for UK importers, forwarders and logistics teams

Issue 1, Monday 12 October 2026

Gales likely to stop cranes at Liverpool on Tuesday as Atlantic storms build

Liverpool faces its worst day on Tuesday, with gusts to 22 m/s from 10:00 to 22:00. Severe to extreme seas across the North Atlantic will hold up ships from North America by 2 days or more, and the Western Approaches turn severe on Wednesday.

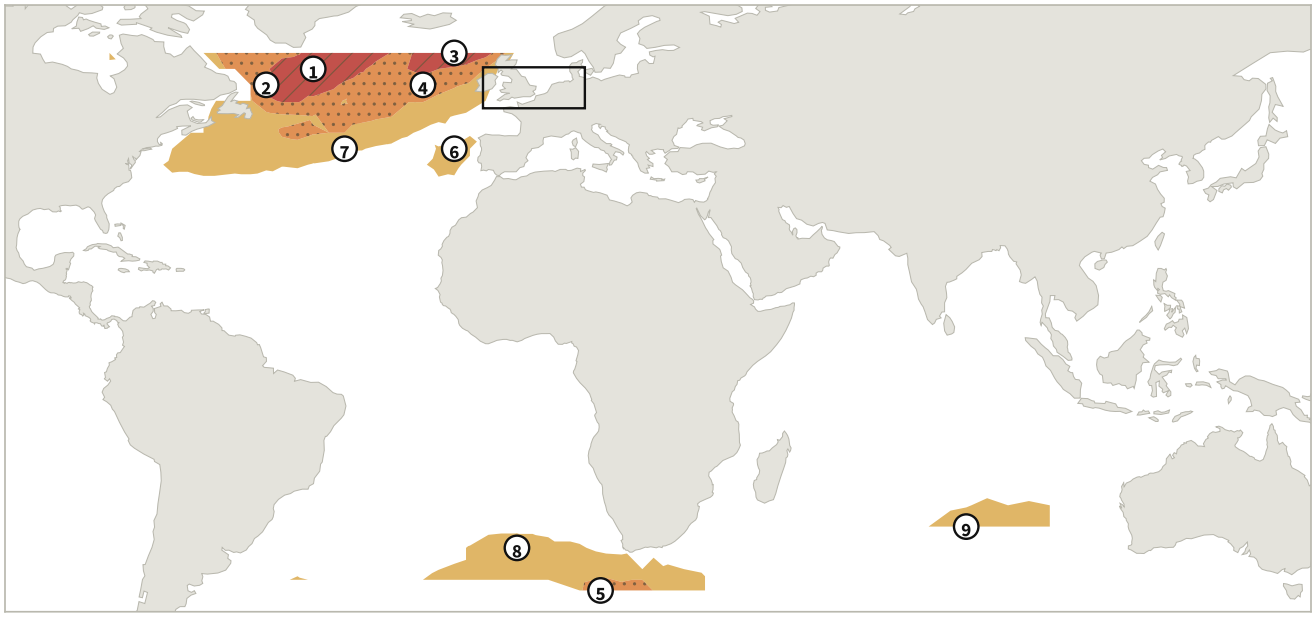
The ports this week

Port	Status	What to do	Detail
United Kingdom			
Felixstowe	Watch	A short gusty spell on Monday evening from 20:00 to 21:00, then settled. Allow 12–24 hours on anything due off the quay tonight and push releases through for the rest of the week.	Windy spell: Mon 20:00–21:00, 15 m/s
Southampton	Watch	Brief gusts near crane limits on Monday and Tuesday mornings. Avoid tight cut-offs on those mornings and allow 12–24 hours.	Windy spells: Mon 10:00–11:00, 16 m/s Tue 09:00–11:00, 16 m/s
London Gateway	Running normally	No crane or pilotage limits forecast all week. A good week to clear releases: speak to your carrier about release and delivery now.	No crane or pilotage limits forecast.
Liverpool	Disruption likely	Cranes are likely to stop on Tuesday from 10:00 to 22:00, with gusts to 22 m/s. Tell your haulier today, move Tuesday collections to Wednesday and allow 24–48 hours.	Windy spells: Tue 07:00–08:00, 16 m/s Tue 10:00–22:00, 22 m/s
North Europe			
Rotterdam	Watch	Short spells near crane limits on Tuesday afternoon and again on Saturday. If you tranship here, allow 12–24 hours on weekend feeder connections.	Windy spells: Tue 16:00–18:00, 15 m/s Fri 21:00–Sat 00:00, 16 m/s Sat 12:00–21:00, 18 m/s
Antwerp	Watch	Gusts near crane limits on Tuesday afternoon, then from Friday evening through Saturday. Allow 12–24 hours on Friday and weekend moves.	Windy spells: Tue 15:00–18:00, 18 m/s Fri 18:00–Sun 00:00, 19 m/s Mon 00:00–01:00, 15 m/s
Bremerhaven	Watch	Windy from Tuesday night into Wednesday morning, and again on Saturday. Allow 12–24 hours on Wednesday vessel calls and avoid tight cut-offs.	Windy spells: Tue 21:00–Wed 10:00, 18 m/s Sat 01:00–08:00, 18 m/s Sat 10:00–13:00, 15 m/s and 1 more
Hamburg	Watch	Gusty on Tuesday and from Tuesday evening to Wednesday 10:00, then again on Saturday. Allow 12–24 hours and keep Wednesday morning plans flexible.	Windy spells: Tue 12:00–15:00, 15 m/s Tue 19:00–Wed 10:00, 19 m/s Sat 01:00–15:00, 18 m/s and 1 more

Congestion figures were not available for this issue, so each status reflects weather forecasts and port news only. Weather times are UK local time. Buffers follow the Port Brief playbook and assume normal carrier free time.

Weather on the routes into Europe

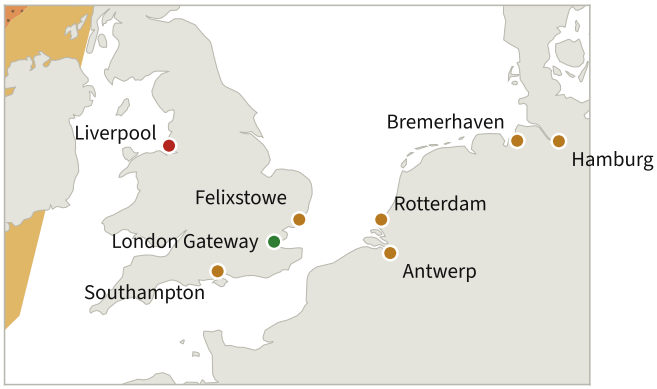
Extreme seas across the North Atlantic, peaking at 11.8 m, mean ships from North America are likely to arrive 2 days or more late. Severe seas in the Western Approaches on Wednesday slow Cape-routed Asia arrivals into the Channel by 1–2 days, so confirm revised ETAs with your carrier before booking haulage.



Highest seas over the next six days: Rough 4 m+, Severe 6 m+, Extreme 8 m+. Numbers refer to the table below. The box is the ports map.

No.	Sea area	Severity	When	Peak seas	Expected delay
1	**Mid-North Atlantic** Transatlantic services from North America	Extreme	Mon 12 Oct to Sun 18 Oct	11.8 m	2 days or more
2	**North-west Atlantic** Transatlantic services from the US East Coast and Canada	Extreme	Mon 12 Oct to Sun 18 Oct	8.8 m	2 days or more
3	**North of Scotland** Northabout routings and Scandinavian services	Extreme	Wed 14 Oct to Sun 18 Oct	10.7 m	Only if routed through it
4	**Western Approaches** Transatlantic and Cape-routed Asia arrivals into the Channel	Severe	Wed 14 Oct to Thu 15 Oct	7.1 m	1–2 days
5	**Cape of Good Hope / Agulhas** Asia–North Europe services routed via the Cape	Severe	Wed 14 Oct to Sat 17 Oct	6.7 m	1–2 days
6	**Off Portugal** Asia, Mediterranean and West Africa services into the UK	Rough	Sat 17 Oct to Sun 18 Oct	5.0 m	Up to 1 day
7	**Azores** Transatlantic and Caribbean services	Rough	Wed 14 Oct	4.7 m	Up to 1 day
8	**South Atlantic** South America East Coast and Cape-routed services	Rough	Mon 12 Oct to Fri 16 Oct	5.1 m	Only if routed through it
9	**Southern Indian Ocean** Australia and Cape-routed services	Rough	Fri 16 Oct to Sat 17 Oct	4.9 m	Only if routed through it

North European ports



Ports coloured by this week's status: running normally, watch, congested, disruption likely.

Forecast changes since the last issue

Liverpool, Tue 13 Oct: gusts 14 to 22 m/s

London Gateway, Fri 16 Oct: gusts 19 to 14 m/s

Six-day forecast at the ports

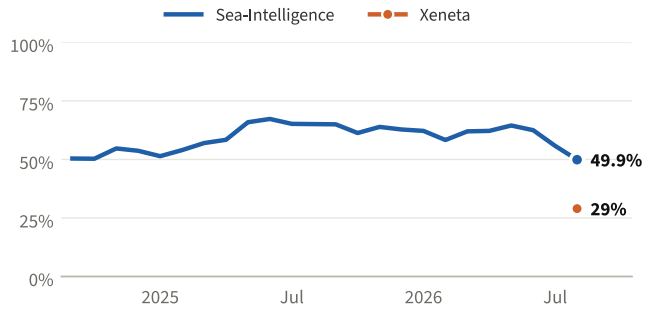
Peak gusts (m/s) and sea (m)	Mon 12	Tue 13	Wed 14	Thu 15	Fri 16	Sat 17	Sun 18
Felixstowe	**15 / 0.9**	14 / 0.9	9 / 0.6	11 / 0.9	12 / 0.7	12 / 1.0	13 / 1.4
Southampton	**16 / 1.3**	**16 / 1.4**	11 / 0.6	12 / 0.9	14 / 1.0	13 / 0.7	14 / 1.3
London Gateway	13 / 0.6	14 / 0.7	9 / 0.4	10 / 0.6	14 / 0.7	15 / 1.5	14 / 2.0
Liverpool	14 / 0.7	**22 / 1.6**	13 / 1.1	15 / 1.1	14 / 1.3	12 / 1.1	10 / 0.4
Rotterdam	13 / 0.6	**15 / 1.3**	12 / 1.0	10 / 0.7	**16 / 1.3**	**18 / 1.7**	12 / 1.5
Antwerp	12 / 0.6	**18 / 1.3**	13 / 0.9	9 / 0.6	**19 / 1.4**	**18 / 1.9**	**15 / 1.8**
Bremerhaven	8 / 0.6	**17 / 1.4**	**18 / 1.5**	11 / 0.9	14 / 1.3	**18 / 1.9**	**16 / 1.6**
Hamburg	9 / 0.8	**18 / 1.8**	**19 / 1.9**	12 / 1.1	14 / 1.5	**18 / 2.2**	**16 / 1.7**

Shaded amber where gusts reach 15 m/s or seas reach 2.5 m, when crane work or pilot boarding may pause; red from 20 m/s or 3.5 m, when it usually stops. Days run midnight to midnight UTC.

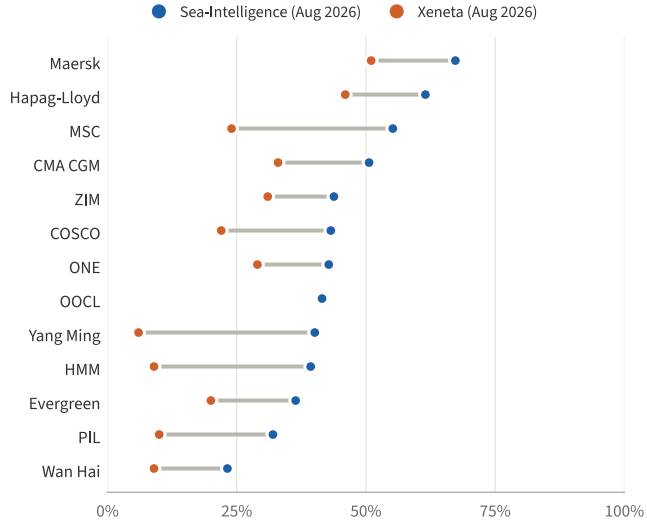
Schedule reliability

Sea-Intelligence puts August global schedule reliability at 49.9%, down 5.9 points on July and 15.2 points on a year earlier. Late ships arrived 6.81 days behind schedule on average. Xeneta measures 29% for the same month. The 20.9-point gap comes from method: Sea-Intelligence counts an arrival as on time within one day of schedule, Xeneta only on the scheduled day. Both rank Maersk and Hapag-Lloyd first and second. With this week's Atlantic storms on top, plan on transatlantic arrivals missing their scheduled day.

Share of ships arriving on time, worldwide



The same carriers, measured two ways, Aug 2026



Carrier	Sea-Intelligence, Aug 2026	Xeneta, Aug 2026	Difference, points
Maersk	67.3%	51%	+16
Hapag-Lloyd	61.5%	46%	+16
MSC	55.2%	24%	+31
CMA CGM	50.6%	33%	+18
ZIM	43.8%	31%	+13
COSCO	43.2%	22%	+21
ONE	42.8%	29%	+14
OOCL	41.5%	Not ranked	
Yang Ming	40.1%	6%	+34
HMM	39.3%	9%	+30
Evergreen	36.4%	20%	+16
PIL	32.0%	10%	+22
Wan Hai	23.2%	9%	+14

Sea-Intelligence counts an arrival as on time if it is within one day of schedule (34 trade lanes, 60+ carriers). Late ships arrived 6.81 days behind schedule on average.

Xeneta counts only arrivals on the scheduled day. Xeneta ranks 12 carriers (OOCL is not listed separately).

Notices from ports and carriers

Hapag-Lloyd has suspended bookings to three Philippine ports as congestion there worsens. MSC has restored a direct service from Karachi to seven European ports. Maersk has raised its US inland haulage fuel surcharge to USD 215 per container, and Hapag-Lloyd has announced a North America GRI. Malaysia is enforcing new cargo manifest rules, which CMA CGM warns could delay cargo there.

Maersk

Maersk raises U.S. inland haulage fuel surcharge to USD 215 per container
Data Portuaria, Mon 12 Oct. New since the last issue

MSC

MSC and ONE to take over Ipanema service VSA from April 2027
DatamarNews, Fri 9 Oct. New since the last issue

MSC Restores Direct Karachi Service to Seven European Ports
Retail News Asia, Fri 9 Oct. New since the last issue

Hapag-Lloyd

Hapag-Lloyd suspends bookings to three Philippine ports as container crisis deepens
Splash247, Mon 12 Oct. New since the last issue

Hapag-Lloyd announces North America GRI
Container News, Mon 5 Oct. New since the last issue

CMA CGM

CMA CGM: Malaysia Enforces New Cargo Manifest Rules, Raising Risk of Port Delays
Breakbulk.News, Fri 9 Oct. New since the last issue

How to read this brief. Weather flags are forecasts, not port notices: they mark the hours when wind or sea is likely to reach the levels at which terminals usually pause crane work or pilots stop boarding. Always confirm with your terminal or carrier before changing plans.

Sources. Headlines link to the original publishers; some discovered via Google News. Port congestion data: Sinay (sinay.ai). Schedule reliability: Sea-Intelligence Global Liner Performance report; Xeneta Schedule Reliability Scorecard. Tropical cyclone data: GDACS (Global Disaster Alert and Coordination System), European Commission JRC / UN OCHA. Weather data by Open-Meteo.com (CC BY 4.0). Maps use Natural Earth data.

Data this issue. weather: complete; storm_field: complete; tropical storms: complete; congestion: not connected; schedule reliability: complete; notices: complete.